

Smart Meter

Billing Clerk User Manual

Step-by-Step Guide to Reviewing and Posting Meter Readings

Version

Date

Audience

System

Hargeisa Water Agency • Smart Metering Portal • Internal Use Only

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Everything you need to confidently review and post meter readings

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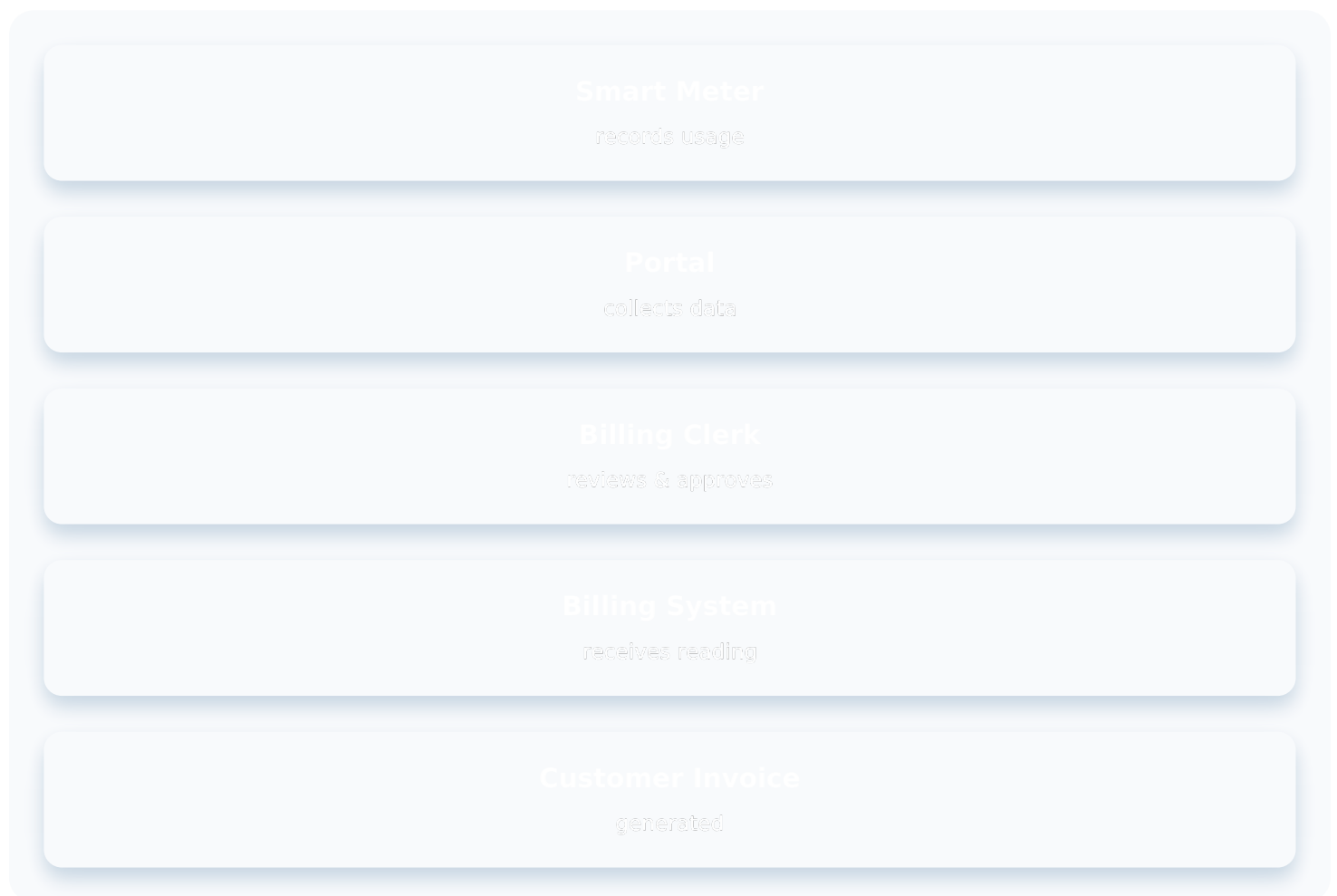
Decode every flash message the portal shows.

Common Questions

Quick answers to day-to-day scenarios.

The **HWA Smart Metering Portal** is a modern, cloud-based tool that connects the water meters installed at customer premises directly to the agency's billing system. It removes most of the manual work of collecting readings, reduces mistakes, and helps customers receive accurate invoices on time.

Here is the journey a single water reading takes — from the physical meter all the way to the customer's invoice:



NOTE

The portal does **not** print or email invoices itself. It only sends approved readings to the billing system. Invoices are created by the downstream billing application using those readings.

Your Role as a Billing Clerk

You are the quality checkpoint in this process. Smart meters are reliable, but a meter can be

damaged, misconfigured, or installed at the wrong property. Your daily tasks include:

- Logging into the portal and reviewing the list of recent meter readings.
- Checking each reading for correct supply number, reasonable value, and correct date.
- Posting valid readings to the billing system, one at a time or in a monthly batch.
- Rejecting faulty readings and notifying the field team or system administrator.
- Watching for warning messages after posting and knowing what action (if any) to take.



TIP

You do not need to be a computer expert to use this system. If you can browse the web and use simple forms, you can master the portal in a short time. This manual will guide you through every screen.

Access to the portal is protected by a username and password. Always sign in from a trusted computer on the HWA network or through the approved remote-access procedure.



Open a web browser

Use Google Chrome, Microsoft Edge, or Mozilla Firefox. Type the portal address into the address bar exactly as shown: `https://billing.hargeisawatertech.com`



Enter your credentials

Type your

Username

and

Password

into the login form. Passwords are case-sensitive, so check Caps Lock is off.



Click Sign In

After a brief loading moment, the

Billing Dashboard

will appear. This is your home screen.



SECURITY WARNING

Never share your password with anyone, and do not write it on paper left near your desk. If you forget your password, contact the IT administrator to reset it. Do not attempt to guess repeatedly — accounts may lock after several failed attempts.

The Dashboard You Will See

Once signed in, the screen is divided into three familiar areas: a top navigation bar, a left sidebar menu, and a large central content area showing recent meter readings.

MENU

 Dashboard

 Readings

 Reports

 Alarms

Recent Meter Readings

65504	J - 28 - 384	212.450	Jul 8 2026	PENDING
65503	J - 28 - 383	89.120	Jul 8 2026	PENDING
65502	J - 28 - 382	156.000	Jul 7 2026	POSTED
65501	J - 28 - 381	0.000	Jul 7 2026	QUEUED
65500	J - 28 - 380	100.621	Jul 8 2026	PENDING



NOTE

If the dashboard does not load, first check your internet connection, then try refreshing the page. If the problem continues, contact the system administrator.

The dashboard is designed to give you an instant overview of the latest meter activity. The large table in the center lists the most recent readings received by the portal, newest first.

What Each Column Means

ID	The unique number the portal assigned to this reading. Click it to open the detail page.
Supply No	The customer account/supply identifier. It must match the account in the billing system.
Reading (m³)	Water consumption shown in cubic meters. (See Section 9 for liters vs. cubic meters.)
Date	The date and time the meter reported the reading.
Status	The current state of the reading: Pending, Posted, Queued/Warning, or Rejected.

Status Badges Explained

Every reading is shown with a colored badge. Learn these colors and you will immediately know what action is needed.

PENDING	Pending	The reading arrived from the meter and is waiting for your review.	Open and review it. Post if valid, reject if faulty.
POSTED	Posted	The reading has been approved and sent to the billing system successfully.	No action. It will be included in the next invoice run.
QUEUED	Queued / Warning	The reading was approved, but the push to billing failed temporarily. The system will retry automatically.	Do not post again. Wait or inform the system administrator if it persists.
REJECTED	Rejected	The reading was judged invalid and will not be billed.	Inform the field team. Cannot be undone from the portal.

Navigation Sidebar

Use the left sidebar to move between the main areas of the portal. As a billing clerk, you will spend most of your time in **Readings** and **Dashboard**. Reports and Alarms are read-only views for monitoring.

https://billing.hargeisawatertech.com/readings

M E N U

Dashboard

Readings

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All Readings

Supply No: J - 28 - 380

From: 2026-07-01

To: 2026-07-31

65500	J - 28 - 380	100.621	Jul 8 2026	PENDING
65012	J - 28 - 380	96.200	Jun 28 2026	POSTED
64503	J - 28 - 380	91.550	May 28 2026	POSTED



TIP

You can click any column header to sort the table, or use the search boxes at the top of the Readings page to find readings by supply number or date range.

Before any reading is sent to billing, you should review it. Reviewing is quick but important — it catches problems that would otherwise appear on a customer invoice.

How to Open a Reading



Go to the Readings list

Click

Readings

in the left sidebar. You will see all readings, with the newest at the top.



Use filters if needed

If the list is long, enter a

Supply No

or a

Date Range

and click

Filter

to narrow the results.



Click the reading ID

Click the blue number in the

ID

column. The detail page will open.

What to Check on the Detail Page

When the detail page opens, look at the following fields carefully:

- **Supply Number** — Does it match a valid customer account? A wrong supply number means the reading may belong to a different property.
- **Reading Value** — Is it reasonable for this customer? A domestic customer suddenly showing 10,000 m³ is probably a meter fault.

- **Reading Time** — Is the date in the current billing month? Old readings should not be posted unless you are running a special correction.
- **Device EUI** — This is the meter's internal serial number. If it does not match the expected meter for this supply, notify the field team.

https://billing.hargeisawatertech.com/readings/65500

M E N U

 Dashboard

 Readings

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Reading Details

ID
65500
Dev EUI
03280830
Supply No
J - 28 - 380
Reading Value
100.621 m ³
Reading Time
Jul 8 2026
Status
PENDING

Reject

**TIP**

If you are unsure whether a value is reasonable, compare it with the customer's previous monthly readings. Most customers show a steady pattern; large jumps or drops are worth investigating.

Posting means approving a reading and sending it to the agency's billing system. Once posted, the reading becomes part of the customer's billing record.



Open the reading detail page

Make sure you have reviewed the reading and that it is correct.



Click the Post Reading button

This is the green button at the bottom of the detail page.



Confirm in the dialog

A dialog will ask: *Post this reading to billing?* Click

Yes

to continue.



System applies the billing date

The portal automatically uses the 28th of the billing month as the official billing date. You do not need to enter a date.



Check the result message

A colored flash message appears at the top of the page telling you whether the post succeeded.

Successful Post Example

When everything works, you will see a green success flash, and the status badge will change from Pending to Posted.

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Reading posted to billing. Successfully posted meter reading.

Reading Details

ID
65500
Dev EUI
03280830
Supply No
J - 28 - 380
Reading Value
100.621 m ³
Billing Date
2026-07-28
Status
POSTED

Sometimes the reading is approved in the portal but the billing server is temporarily unavailable. In that case you will see a yellow warning flash. The system will automatically retry the push.

https://billing.hargeisawatertech.com/readings/65501

MENU

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Reading approved, but the billing push failed and will be retried.

Reading Details

ID
65501
Supply No
J - 28 - 381
Status
QUEUED



IMPORTANT

If you see the yellow warning above, **do NOT post the reading again**. The portal has already marked it for retry. Posting again will not help and may create duplicates. Wait a few minutes and refresh the page. If the status remains Queued after an hour, inform the system administrator.

Rejecting tells the portal that a reading is invalid and should not be used for billing. Use this option carefully; rejected readings cannot be reinstated by a billing clerk.

When to Reject a Reading

- The value is zero or clearly impossible for the customer.
- The supply number does not match the meter location.
- The meter is known to be faulty, disconnected, or replaced.
- The reading time is far outside the current billing period and appears to be stale data.

Steps to Reject



Open the reading detail page

Navigate to the reading you want to reject and click its ID.



Click the Reject button

This is the red-outlined button next to Post Reading.



Confirm the rejection

A dialog will ask you to confirm. Click

Yes

only if you are sure.



Check the status

The status badge will change to **REJECTED** and the page will show a confirmation message.

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Reading rejected. This reading will not be posted to billing.

Reading Details

ID
65499
Supply No
J - 28 - 379
Reading Value
0.000 m ³
Status
REJECTED



WARNING — CANNOT BE UNDONE

Once a reading is rejected, you cannot change it back from the portal. If you made a mistake, contact the system administrator immediately. They may be able to reverse the rejection from the backend.

At the end of each billing cycle, you can post all remaining pending readings for the month in one operation. This is faster than posting them one by one and ensures the whole batch uses the same official billing date.



WHEN TO USE BULK POST

Use bulk post after the 28th of the month, when most meters have already reported their monthly readings. Do not run it before the 28th unless you have been instructed to do so, because readings received later in the month may be skipped or treated as duplicates.



Go to Readings and click Post to Billing

At the top of the Readings list, click the blue **Post to Billing** button.



Select the billing month

Choose the month from the dropdown, for example **2026-07**.



Confirm and wait

The system will process every pending reading for that month. This may take a minute if there are many readings.



Review the summary message

A flash message will tell you how many readings were posted, how many failed, and how many were skipped.

Successful Bulk Post Example

https://billing.hargeisawatertech.com/readings/bulk-post

M E N U

Dashboard

Readings

Reports

Alarms

✓

47 reading(s) posted for 2026-07-28, 3 skipped.

Bulk Post Summary

Pending readings found	50
Successfully posted	47
Skipped (zero or already posted)	3

Partial Success Example

MENU

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44 posted, 3 failed (queued for retry), 3 skipped for 2026-07-28.

The 3 failed readings have been queued for automatic retry. Do not run bulk post again unless instructed.



WHY ARE READINGS SKIPPED?

A reading is skipped during bulk post when it is either a zero reading or already posted. Skipped readings are normal and require no action.

HWA uses a fixed billing date to keep invoices consistent. Every monthly reading is posted to the billing system with the date **28** of that month, regardless of the day the meter actually transmitted the reading.



COMPANY POLICY

HWA uses the 28th of each month as the official billing date. This applies to single posts and bulk posts automatically.

How the Date Is Applied

28th of the month	2026-07-28	Standard monthly reading.
7th of the month	2026-07-28	Posted early but recorded as the 28th with an automatic description note.
No reading before the 28th	—	Reading is skipped for that month. No invoice will be generated from this meter.



YOU DO NOT NEED TO ENTER THE DATE

The portal applies the 28th billing date automatically. You only need to click Post Reading or run the bulk post; the system handles the rest.

Smart meters transmit water usage as a count of liters. The portal converts that number into cubic meters (m³) because water bills are calculated in m³. One cubic meter equals one thousand liters.

Common Conversions

100,621 L	100.621 m³	Portal display and billing record
52,789 L	52.789 m³	Portal display and billing record
1,500 L	1.500 m³	Portal display and billing record



BILLING SERVER ROUNDS DOWN

The billing server receives the value rounded down to the nearest whole cubic meter. For example, a reading of **100.621 m³** is sent to billing as **100 m³**. The decimal portion is not lost in the portal, but the downstream billing system uses whole units.

The portal shows short flash messages after you post, reject, or bulk-process readings. The table below explains every message you are likely to see and what to do about it.

✓	Reading posted to billing. Successfully posted meter reading.	All good. The reading is approved and pushed to billing.	No action needed.
✓	X reading(s) posted for 2026-07-28, Y skipped.	Bulk post succeeded. Some readings may have been skipped because they were zero or already posted.	No action needed. Review skipped count if unusually high.
⚠	Reading approved, but the billing push failed and will be retried.	The portal accepted the reading, but the billing server could not be reached. Retry is automatic.	Wait. Do NOT post again. Inform admin if it remains queued.
⚠	X posted, Y failed (queued for retry), Z skipped.	Partial bulk success. Some pushes failed but are queued for retry.	Wait for retry. Inform the system administrator if failures persist.
✗	Zero reading; not posted to billing.	The meter reported zero usage, which is not valid for billing.	Contact the field team to check the meter.
✗	Reading has no supply number.	The meter is not linked to a customer account.	Ask the system administrator to assign a supply number.
✗	Only pending readings can be posted.	The reading is already posted, rejected, or queued.	No action. Refresh the page to see the current status.



KEEP CALM

Most messages are either success confirmations or routine skips. Only red messages or persistent yellow warnings need follow-up.

Below are answers to questions billing clerks often ask. If your question is not listed here, ask your supervisor or the system administrator.

Can I post the same reading twice?

No. The portal detects duplicates automatically. If a reading has already been posted, any further attempt will be skipped and you will see a message such as *Only pending readings can be posted* or the reading will be counted as skipped in a bulk run.

What if I accidentally reject a reading?

Contact the system administrator immediately. The portal does not allow clerks to undo a rejection, but an administrator may be able to reverse it from the backend if caught quickly.

Why did I get a yellow warning after posting?

The billing server was temporarily unavailable. The portal has queued the reading for retry and will try again automatically. Do not post again. If the warning remains for more than an hour, inform the system administrator.

The reading value looks wrong — what should I do?

Reject the reading and notify your supervisor and the field team. Do not post a value you believe is incorrect. Include the supply number and reading ID in your message.

I posted a reading but no invoice appeared. Why?

Check the portal status first. If it shows **POSTED**, wait a few minutes for the billing system to process it. If it still shows **PENDING** or **QUEUED**, contact the system administrator.

What does already posted for this supply mean?

This is normal if you run bulk post more than once for the same month. The duplicate reading is counted as skipped. No action is needed — the customer will not be double-billed.



STILL NEED HELP?

For technical issues, contact the HWA IT Help Desk. For billing policy questions, speak with your billing supervisor.